MAYA ANGELOU · WHEN I THINK ABOUT MYSELF

LAUGHTER HOLDS BOTH PRIDE AND PAIN

In Maya Angelou’s poem, the speaker navigates degrading labor and communal hardship, using laughter not for amusement, but as an enduring mask that gives way to grief.

Interpretive study of Stanzas 1–3 (lines 1–21) · Metaphor of unequal harvest



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